

AGENDA FOR A LIVING WAY

A Programme of Action for Living Men and Women
Reclaiming Land, Well-being, Sovereignty and Knowledge

Assembled by free souls in common consent
Draft Edition — Year One of the Living Compact

There is no one between a living man or woman and God.

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Agenda for a Living Way — Chapter 1

PREAMBLE

There is no one between a living man or woman and God.

On the coined word SOLVEN. No existing word for a gathered body of living souls is free of jurisdiction. Community derives from Latin *communitas* — an administered common body. Society from *socius* — a partner bound by Roman contract. Kindred and fellowship carry the -ship of maritime law. Folk and tribe have been made trivial or pejorative by modern use. This document therefore coins the word **SOLVEN** — rooted in *sol*, the sun, the only sovereign that stands above all land without a deed, a flag or a court — to mean: a free gathering of living souls on land, bound by will and common purpose under God and the living order of creation, answering to no earthly institution. A single such gathering is a SOLVEN. Many are SOLVENS. Wherever this document formerly used community, kindred, folk or similar words, the word SOLVEN now stands.

1.1

The living world did not break by accident. It was broken by a series of deliberate abstractions: the enclosure of land, the privatisation of water, the patenting of seed, the monopoly of money creation, and the suppression of knowledge that would have made dependency unnecessary. This document names those abstractions and proposes their reversal.

1.2

Before all else, a word must be said about language. The word 'person' is a legal fiction — a mask placed over a living soul by jurisdictional systems that require subjects to govern. The word 'human being' carries the same stain: it is the language of registration, of census, of administered lives. This Agenda uses neither. Those who act on it are living men, living women, living souls, living solvens. They stand under no authority but the living God and the natural order. No institution, no treaty, no administrative body and no statute stands between a living soul and its Creator. This is not a claim made to any court. It is a statement of what has always been true.

1.3

The dominant agenda for environmental protection has, in practice, extended the separation of living souls from the natural world. By designating nature as a resource to be managed, it has deepened the assumption that a man or woman requires institutional permission to inhabit, cultivate, build upon or heal themselves within the earth. This Agenda proceeds from the opposite premise: the natural world is not a resource. It is home. Living souls belong inside it, not outside it administering it.

1.4

The modern city, as currently organised, functions as a mechanism of dependency. Food arrives from distances that render its origin invisible. Water passes through systems controlled by remote administrators. Energy is metered and billed. Tally is borrowed into existence bearing interest. Shelter requires licensed contractors, approved materials and debt instruments spanning generations. The cumulative effect is not prosperity but permanent obligation — living souls structurally incapable of withdrawal from the systems that govern them.

1.5

This Agenda does not call for revolt. It calls for building. A man who knows how to build a house with his hands teaches one who does not. A woman who understands soil electricity shares that knowledge openly. Those who have recovered clean diets and clean water become living evidence that good well-being is ordinary, not exceptional. The institutions of control become progressively irrelevant not through confrontation but through substitution.

1.6

The programme areas in this document are described in terms of: Basis for Action — what is currently broken and why; Objectives — what a living assembly seeks to establish; Activities — concrete steps that living souls can begin without waiting for permission; and Means of Propagation — how knowledge and practice spread between solvens.

1.7

This Agenda references no existing jurisdiction, no nation-state, no supranational body and no corporate entity. It is the product of common agreement among free souls who have chosen to act. It does not supersede any statute. It operates in the space that has always existed beneath every statute: voluntary cooperation between living souls under God.

1.8

What follows is a beginning. The chapters are programme areas, not prescriptions. Each solven of free souls will find its own application. The Agenda lives when living men and women act on it — and grows as they record what they learn.

SECTION I

FOUNDATIONS OF LIVING SOVEREIGNTY

Sovereignty begins with the capacity to feed oneself, house oneself, move without permission and exchange value without debt. The following three chapters address the material foundations without which all other freedoms remain theoretical.

COMMON TALLY AND EXCHANGE WITHOUT DEBT

On the coined word TALLY. The word currency derives from the Latin *currere* — to run, to flow as a current of the sea — and belongs to the language of maritime trade and the admiralty courts that governed it. It carries their jurisdiction in its root. This document coins instead the word **TALLY**, after the ancient tally stick: a split piece of wood on which an exchange was notched, each party keeping one half, matched together to settle the account. The tally required no bank, no ship, no court and no sea. It was the instrument of free souls exchanging on land under God. Wherever this document speaks of a TALLY, it means any medium of exchange agreed upon freely by living souls — whether marked wood, written ledger or cryptographic record — that carries no interest, answers to no admiral and flows through no maritime current.

A. The Problem of Debt Money

2.1

All dominant exchange systems in the present world are created as interest-bearing debt. Every unit lent into circulation was lent into existence. The interest on that lending was never created — meaning the total debt always exceeds the total supply of the exchange medium. This is not a flaw in the system. It is the system. Perpetual collective indebtedness is its designed output.

2.2

A solven of free souls that depends entirely on debt-money is permanently exposed to the entities that create that money. Price controls, credit denial, inflation and capital flight are instruments of coercion that operate through monetary dependency. A solven that has developed its own medium of exchange — even partially — has reduced that exposure.

2.3

Historically, many forms of living tally have operated successfully: grain receipts, mutual credit systems, labour-hours, stamp scrip, and gift economies operating alongside conventional trade. These are not utopian proposals. They are documented practices with extensive operational histories.

B. Objectives

2.4 A solven of living souls should aim to:

- Establish a medium of exchange based on mutual credit, labour or recorded contribution — not on borrowed money bearing interest.
- Ensure that the new tally is non-convertible to dominant debt systems at the solven's discretion, preventing extraction by arbitrage.
- Record transactions in open, assembly-held ledgers — whether physical or cryptographic — that no single soul controls.
- Allow the tally to extinguish itself: a unit created by contribution should be retired when the corresponding obligation is fulfilled.
- Expand the tally's acceptance organically through demonstrated usefulness rather than mandated adoption.

C. Activities

2.5

A solven of free souls should identify its existing productive capacities — food, construction, craft, transport, teaching, care — and map these against unmet needs. The gap between capacity and need defines the economic space the new tally can occupy.

2.6

A founding circle should agree on the unit of account. Labour-hour denominations have proven the most durable, as they equalise the value of different forms of work and require no external reference price.

2.7

Technical infrastructure should be as simple as possible. Paper ledgers and handshake verification have operated living tallies for centuries. Cryptographic ledgers are an option where the solven has technical capacity — but complexity should not be a barrier to beginning.

2.8

Solvens already operating their own tally should document their models — failures and successes — and make these records available to others. The propagation of working examples is more persuasive than any theoretical argument.

2.9

Trade between solvens using different living tallies should be facilitated through direct barter of surpluses or negotiated exchange ratios, bypassing debt-tally conversion wherever possible.

2.10

The new tally must not replicate the pathologies of the old: hoarding must be discouraged through demurrage mechanisms if necessary; governance of the ledger must remain distributed; and issuance must be tied to real contribution rather than to the creditworthiness of borrowers.

THE RIGHT TO BUILD: SHELTER AS KNOWLEDGE

A. Basis for Action

3.1

The capacity to build one's own shelter is among the most fundamental competencies of a living soul. It was practised continuously across all solvens for the entirety of recorded life until approximately the twentieth century. Its displacement by a licensed, regulated, credit-financed construction industry has produced shelter costs that now consume the majority of a man or woman's working life — and has left most free souls unable to raise the simplest structure without professional assistance.

3.2

Natural building traditions — cob, rammed earth, timber frame, bamboo, stone, adobe — require no industrial supply chain. Their materials are local, their techniques are learnable in weeks, their maintenance is performed by those who dwell within, and their thermal performance in climatic context is equal to or superior to industrial construction. These traditions were not abandoned because they were inferior. They were made illegal or impractical in most jurisdictions to sustain the construction economy.

3.3

The recovery of building knowledge is therefore not merely practical. It is the dissolution of one of the primary mechanisms by which living souls are bound to debt for the whole of their working years.

B. Objectives

3.4 A solven of living souls should aim to:

- Recover and document traditional and natural building methods suited to local climate and materials.
- Establish knowledge-sharing structures — apprenticeships, building schools, communal builds — in which those who know teach those who do not.
- Build at least one communal structure in each settlement using entirely local materials and shared labour, as demonstration and training.
- Develop material repositories — seed libraries, tool banks, material stores — so that building capacity is not lost when any single soul moves on.
- Resist, where a solven has the means, the extension of regulatory frameworks into spaces where natural building is currently practised freely.

C. Activities

3.5

A solven should seek out its eldest souls with building knowledge and record their methods in full — measured drawings, photographic sequences, material sourcing, seasonal considerations. This practical knowledge is irreplaceable once lost.

3.6

Communal building events — in which a new structure is raised collectively over several days — function simultaneously as skill transfer, living-bond strengthening and practical demonstration. They should be organised regularly and opened to visiting souls from neighbouring solvens.

3.7

Solvens should develop compact building guides specific to their land: what materials are available locally, what climate conditions must be addressed, which traditional forms have proven durable. These guides should be printed, not only digital, so they survive infrastructure failure.

3.8

The design principle should be longevity and repairability. A well-built cob or stone structure lasts centuries with minimal maintenance. Industrial construction is designed for replacement cycles that perpetuate dependency. A solven should build things that outlast the need to build them again.

3.9

Where a solven includes souls with skills in passive solar design, earthworks, water harvesting integration and thermal mass, these should be incorporated into building practice from the outset. A well-designed natural dwelling requires no external energy for heating or cooling in most climates.

FREE ENERGY AND CLEAN PROPULSION

A. Basis for Action

4.1

Numerous engine designs capable of operating on variable fuels — including locally produced alcohols, biogas, water-derived hydrogen and compressed air — exist in historical patent archives, private collections and suppressed technical literature. Many were operational. Some were produced in small series before their makers encountered legal, financial or physical opposition. The recovery and open documentation of these designs is a priority.

4.2

The dominant internal combustion engine and its associated petrochemical supply chain represent not a technical optimum but a political-economic settlement reached in the early twentieth century. Alternative propulsion technologies were technically viable at the same moment and in several cases demonstrated superior efficiency. Their suppression was deliberate.

4.3

A solven of free souls does not need to resolve the entire history of energy suppression before acting. It needs to identify which locally available fuel sources can power transport and productive equipment — and which engine configurations can use those sources without exhaust emissions harmful to air quality.

B. Objectives

- Recover, test and openly document engine designs capable of operating on locally produced fuels without toxic emissions.
- Establish open workshops where these designs can be replicated, tested and improved by any living soul with the will to learn.
- Reduce dependency on imported petroleum for transport and agricultural equipment within a defined programme period.
- Develop local fuel production capacity — biogas digesters, alcohol stills, biochar gasifiers — alongside compatible engine platforms.
- Place all recovered designs in the commons without patent restriction.

C. Activities

4.4

Solvens should establish archive recovery teams to search patent databases (particularly pre-1960 US and European filings), university engineering libraries and private collections for suppressed or abandoned engine designs meeting the criteria of fuel-flexibility and clean combustion.

4.5

Recovered designs should be rendered in modern drawing formats, annotated with material specifications, and published to decentralised repositories that cannot be taken offline by any single legal or corporate action.

4.6

Open workshops — physical spaces with machining tools and a culture of shared modification — should be established in each region as the primary site of engine development. Knowledge generated in these workshops is immediately shared with the network.

4.7

Solvens with existing mechanical skills should prioritise the conversion of agricultural equipment — tillers, pumps, generators — before vehicle conversion. Agricultural energy independence has immediate food-sovereignty implications.

SECTION II

LAND, FOOD AND WATER

The sovereignty of a living soul begins with what the body consumes. Food, water and air are not commodities. They are the conditions of life itself. The following chapters address the recovery of clean land, clean water and a clean sky — and the agricultural knowledge that makes this possible.

ELECTROCULTURE, PERMACULTURE AND THE END OF POISONS

A. Basis for Action

5.1

Electroculture — the application of atmospheric electricity, magnetism and geometric antenna structures to stimulate plant growth — has a documented experimental history stretching from the 1700s to the mid-twentieth century. Researchers including Justin Christofleau, Viktor Schauburger and numerous agricultural experimenters demonstrated significant yield increases, enhanced pest resistance and accelerated germination without any chemical inputs. This knowledge was marginalised as synthetic fertilisers and pesticides became the foundation of a global agrochemical industry.

5.2

Permaculture — the design of agricultural systems based on observation of natural processes, polyculture and closed nutrient cycles — has been developed and practised since the 1970s with documented success across climates and scales. Together, electroculture and permaculture represent a complete agricultural system requiring no external chemical inputs, producing no toxic residues and improving soil quality with each growing cycle.

5.3

Industrial agriculture currently destroys approximately one centimetre of topsoil per year globally while its pesticide regime disrupts insect life foundational to the living world's function. Solvens adopting clean agricultural practice are not only feeding themselves — they are rebuilding the biological infrastructure that industrial agriculture is destroying.

B. Objectives

- Establish demonstration farms in each bioregion practising integrated electroculture and permaculture without any synthetic chemical inputs.
- Document and share electroculture apparatus designs — copper antennae, magnetite soil treatments, spiral water conditioners — that a living soul can build locally.
- Develop seed sovereignty: open-pollinated, locally adapted seed banks under assembly control.
- Measure and publish soil vitality indicators annually so that the regeneration of degraded land is a visible, documented process.
- Train a new generation of land designers in whole-system observation rather than input-output management.

C. Activities

5.4

A solven should immediately begin composting all organic waste. Living soil is the foundation of everything that follows. No further inputs are required to begin improving soil biology — and the knowledge to do this is freely available.

5.5

Electroculture antenna installations — the simplest of which are copper spirals driven into growing beds — require no tools beyond basic metalworking and can be built for negligible cost. Each solven should trial these in controlled plots alongside conventional beds and record the results rigorously.

5.6

Food forests — perennial polyculture systems modelled on woodland edge — should be planted as a priority. A mature food forest requires almost no labour and produces continuous yield across multiple canopy layers. Establishment takes three to five years; the return is multigenerational.

5.7

Solvans should catalogue their local wild food and medicinal plant knowledge immediately, as this knowledge rests disproportionately with the eldest souls. Wild food skills reduce food-sovereignty vulnerability to any form of disruption.

5.8

The transition away from synthetic fertilisers should be gradual and evidence-based. A solven should not reduce inputs before soil biology has been sufficiently restored to support yields. Biochar production, legume incorporation and mycorrhizal inoculation are the primary tools of soil restoration.

CLEAN FOOD AND THE DISSOLUTION OF INDUSTRIAL CHEMISTRY

A. Basis for Action

6.1

The proposition is simple and ancient: a living soul flourishes on clean food in its natural form, clean water and clean air. This was not controversial before the twentieth century. It has been made controversial by the commercial interests that profit from its opposite.

6.2

Industrial food processing introduces a range of chemical compounds — preservatives, emulsifiers, synthetic flavourings, seed oils extracted by solvent, refined sugars, nitrites, and additives whose long-term effects have been systematically understudied — into daily consumption at quantities that would have been incomprehensible to any prior living solven. The chronic disease burden of industrialised settlements tracks closely with the introduction of these compounds.

6.3

The food industry's chemical dependency is not necessary for food security. It is necessary for shelf life, long supply chains, and the profitability of intermediary processors. A solven that produces and consumes food locally has no need for most of these compounds.

6.4

Clean food requires: whole foods grown without synthetic pesticides; animals living naturally on appropriate diets; water uncontaminated by industrial or pharmaceutical run-off; and preparation methods that do not destroy nutritional content. These are entirely achievable by any free solven.

B. Objectives

- Transition the solven's food supply progressively toward local, chemical-free production measurable by defined criteria.
- Eliminate ultra-processed food products through substitution rather than prohibition.
- Establish fermentation, preservation and storage traditions that eliminate the need for chemical preservatives.
- Teach the young — especially children — the preparation of whole foods from primary ingredients.
- Document the well-being outcomes of solvens adopting clean diets and make this evidence available to all.

WATER AS SACRED COMMONS

A. Basis for Action

7.1

Water is not a resource. It is a living system. Viktor Schaubberger's work in the early twentieth century demonstrated that water carries biological and energetic qualities that are destroyed by straight-pipe, pressure-driven distribution and restored by spiral, vortical movement mimicking natural watercourses. Water treatment and distribution should preserve rather than degrade water's living properties.

7.2

Fluoridation, chlorination and the pharmaceutical contamination of water supplies through inadequate filtration represent a chemical burden on the living soul that has been consistently minimised in official assessments. Solvens with the capacity to provide alternative clean water sources should do so without delay.

7.3

Rainwater harvesting, natural spring development, borehole access and the restoration of wetlands that recharge aquifers are land-scale water strategies that reduce dependence on centralised systems. The infrastructure is simple, the knowledge is available and the results are immediate.

B. Objectives

- Establish assembly-controlled water sources independent of centralised chemical treatment.
- Develop and disseminate simple water quality testing protocols so any solven can monitor its own supply.
- Restore riparian vegetation and wetland areas that regulate local water cycles.
- Introduce vortex-based water revitalisation systems documented by Schaubberger and monitor outcomes honestly.
- Recognise water sovereignty as a foundational right of every living soul in all assembly agreements.

RETURNING THE SKY: ATMOSPHERIC RESTORATION

A. Basis for Action

8.1

The sky should be blue. This is not an aesthetic preference but a diagnostic statement. A blue sky over a given land indicates that combustion aerosols, particulates and other airborne contaminants are below the threshold of visible interference. In many regions this standard is no longer routinely met. Its restoration is a measurable objective and a right of every living soul.

8.2

The most significant contributions to atmospheric degradation at land level are: internal combustion exhaust; open burning of agricultural waste and synthetic materials; industrial emissions from proximate facilities; and, increasingly documented, intentional aerosol dispersal at altitude for which living souls should demand transparency and accountability from those responsible.

8.3

Trees are the primary atmospheric restoration technology. A solven that plants trees — particularly species suited to its bioregion — simultaneously improves air quality, rebuilds water cycles, stabilises soil, sequesters carbon and provides long-term material. No technical substitute for trees exists.

8.4

The transition of agricultural and transport equipment to non-combustion or clean-combustion energy systems (see Chapter 4) is the primary mechanical contribution to air quality. This is achievable progressively and is not contingent on any political agreement.

SECTION III

WELL-BEING AND KNOWLEDGE

A living soul that cannot heal itself and cannot teach its young is permanently dependent on institutions that profit from both incapacities. The recovery of knowledge of well-being and the restoration of education as the transmission of living wisdom — rather than the production of compliant subjects — are acts of restoration of the living way.

HEALTH WITHOUT INTERMEDIARIES: THE LIVING BODY UNDERSTOOD

A. Basis for Action

9.1

Medicine, as presently constituted, is a disease-management industry. Its economic model requires chronic illness as its input. A living soul whose food is clean, whose water is clean, whose air is clean, whose sleep is sufficient and whose bonds with kin are coherent does not generate the patient volume on which the pharmaceutical industry depends. This is not a conspiracy theory. It is a description of incentive structures.

9.2

The proposition at the centre of this chapter is both ancient and obvious: wellbeing = clean food in natural form + clean water + clean air + movement + sunlight + living bonds + meaningful work + sleep. Each of these conditions is knowable, achievable and independent of any medical institution. Their systematic disruption has created the chronic disease burden that modern medicine then manages, profitably, with compounds that address symptoms rather than causes.

9.3

No institution stands between a living soul and its own body. No licence is required for a man to understand his own well-being, for a woman to tend the sick of her solven, or for a solven to decide how it heals itself. This Agenda does not oppose emergency intervention or the treatment of injury. It opposes the colonisation of ordinary living by pharmaceutical management — the conversion of natural processes into medical events requiring institutional permission.

9.4

Traditional healing — Ayurveda, Traditional Chinese Medicine, European herbalism, Indigenous healing — maintained the well-being of living solven for millennia. These were not primitive practices. They were displaced by a legal and commercial apparatus that restricted healing to those holding credentials aligned with pharmaceutical treatment protocols.

9.5

The recovery of traditional healing knowledge, the practice of clean-food medicine, and the restoration of living well-being capacity are not alternatives to be debated. They are practical necessities for solvens that cannot afford pharmaceutical institutional medicine and do not wish to depend on it.

B. Objectives

- Document traditional healing knowledge from the eldest souls of each solven before it is lost.
- Establish living herb gardens and medicinal plant nurseries within each settlement.
- Train healing practitioners in whole-soul assessment: food, land, sleep, movement, living bonds.
- Reduce pharmaceutical dependency by addressing the root conditions that generate it.
- Develop clear understanding of which conditions require emergency intervention and which are addressable by living restoration.

RECOVERY OF SUPPRESSED TECHNICAL KNOWLEDGE

A. Basis for Action

10.1

Technical knowledge has been suppressed in at least three ways: patent acquisition and non-development by commercial interests; regulatory exclusion of working devices from approved certification frameworks; and the destruction or deliberate inaccessibility of primary sources. The practical result is a way of living less technically capable than it should be, dependent on commercial systems for technologies it could produce from its own land.

10.2

Priority areas for knowledge recovery include: alternative propulsion and energy systems (Chapter 4); agricultural electroculture (Chapter 5); natural building techniques (Chapter 3); traditional medicine and plant pharmacology (Chapter 9); and methods of water revitalisation and soil restoration.

10.3

Archive recovery requires systematic, patient work. Patent offices, university libraries, private collections and digitised historical publications all contain knowledge buried not by deletion but by obscurity. Solvens should support readers, translators and experimenters — those whose calling is to find what has been forgotten and test whether it works.

10.4

All recovered knowledge should be placed immediately into the commons with full documentation. The knowledge itself is the living inheritance; its restriction is the wound. A solven that recovers knowledge and publishes it freely is performing a service to all living souls.

EDUCATION AS TRANSMISSION: LIVING AND ELDER-GUIDED

A. Basis for Action

11.1

Industrial schooling was designed, explicitly, to produce disciplined, compliant subjects and consumers. Its structure — age-segregated cohorts, standardised curricula, standardised assessment, credentialled gatekeeping — replicates the factory and prepares the young for it. It does not transmit the practical knowledge of how to live: how to grow food, build shelter, heal the body, navigate living land or participate in assembly governance.

11.2

Real education has always been intergenerational. The young learn what those around them know and practise. Where a solven knows how to build, the young learn to build. Where a solven grows food, the young grow food. The separation of learning from living — the removal of the young from productive solven life into dedicated institutional spaces — is a modern invention, not an improvement.

11.3

This Agenda upholds the restoration of intergenerational, mixed-age, practice-based learning as the primary educational model. Reading, counting and clear thinking are best developed in the context of meaningful work, not in abstraction from it.

11.4

A young soul who understands how to grow food, raise a structure, identify healing plants, read the weather, maintain a tool and participate in assembly is genuinely educated. A young soul who has passed every standardised test but can do none of these things is not.

SECTION IV

ASSEMBLY AND GOVERNANCE

Solvens of free souls that know how to feed themselves, house themselves, heal themselves and teach their young still require forms of coordination. The following chapters address how living solven can govern themselves without reproducing the hierarchies they are withdrawing from.

THE LIVING SETTLEMENT: BEYOND THE MANAGED CITY

A. Basis for Action

12.1

The modern city as designed since the mid-twentieth century has served to concentrate living souls in forms that maximise administrative control and commercial extraction. High-density towers, single-use zoning, private-car dependency and the exclusion of food production from settled space are not solutions to the problem of dwelling. They are problems dressed as solutions.

12.2

A living settlement — at whatever scale — integrates food production, shelter, water, energy and assembly in walkable proximity. Those who dwell within it know their food growers, know their builders, know their healers, and know those who tend the shared spaces. This is not an agrarian fantasy. It is the description of every living solven that endured.

12.3

Solvens developing living settlements should resist the reproduction of managed-city assumptions: separation of uses, centralised infrastructure, administrative approval as a precondition of habitation. The settlement should be shaped around those who dwell in it, not around the systems designed to administer them.

12.4

Density is not inherently problematic. The old walled city at high density was clean, productive and coherent. The problem is not density but the absence of the integrating elements — food, water, living bond — that make density livable. A solven should design for integration, not for management.

ASSEMBLY, CONSENT AND NON-HIERARCHICAL COORDINATION

A. Basis for Action

13.1

Every form of governance that has concentrated power into permanent hierarchies has eventually become a mechanism of extraction from those it governs. This is not a flaw in specific men. It is a structural consequence of hierarchy itself. Living solvens require coordination structures that do not permanently concentrate power in any soul, family or institution. Above all solvens stands God alone.

13.2

Consensus-based assembly — in which decisions affecting the whole require the genuine assent of those affected — is the most robust governance model known. It is slower than authoritarian decision-making. It is more durable, more legitimate and less prone to capture. Solvens should invest in the facilitation skills that make consensus assembly practical at their scale.

13.3

Rotating tending — in which coordination roles are held for defined periods by different souls, without the accumulation of institutional power in the role — prevents the emergence of permanent governing classes. A solven should design its coordination around the assumption that any living soul may hold any role, and structure roles accordingly.

13.4

Conflict resolution should aim at restoration rather than punishment. The goal is the repair of living bonds and the restoration of assembly coherence, not the exclusion of souls. Solvens with functional restorative processes are more enduring than those that export their conflict resolution to external judicial systems.

RELATIONSHIP WITH INDIGENOUS AND TRADITIONAL KINDREDS

A. Basis for Action

14.1

Indigenous and traditional solven are not repositories of quaint customs. They are living ways that maintained sophisticated, stable bonds with the living world for spans that dwarf the entire duration of industrial the living way. The knowledge they carry — of soil, water, plant, creature, weather and living assembly — is irreplaceable and is currently being lost.

14.2

Solvens adopting this Agenda should approach neighbouring indigenous and traditional solven with the explicit posture of those who come to learn, not to teach. The direction of knowledge transfer required by of the living way restoration is from older solven to newer solvens, not the reverse.

14.3

The living knowledge of a solven belongs to that solven. It should not be extracted, documented and placed in external repositories without the full and continuing consent of those who hold it. bond, not extraction, is the only honourable mode of engagement between living souls.

SECTION V

MEANS OF LIVING IMPLEMENTATION

The living way does not need institutional approval to begin. It needs living souls who act, and networks that spread what they learn.

NETWORK PROPAGATION AND THE SPREAD OF THE COMPACT

15.1

This Agenda spreads when living souls act on it and document what they learn. Every solven that establishes a working living tally, a natural building programme, a clean food system or a permaculture demonstration farm is producing evidence more persuasive than any written argument.

15.2

Documentation should be systematic, honest and open. What worked and why. What failed and why. What was attempted and abandoned. The network learns from failures as effectively as from successes. Selective publication of successes only is a form of dishonesty the living network cannot afford.

15.3

Physical visits between solvens — in which those who act observe and learn from each other directly — are more effective than any remote exchange. Solvens should support travel between solvens as an investment in network resilience.

15.4

This document should be translated, adapted to local conditions and reprinted wherever solvens find it useful. The original text holds no authority over its adaptations. Take what is useful and leave what is not.

15.5

The network has no centre. There is no governing council and no certification body. A solven that adopts this Agenda does so because it has read it and chosen to act. That is sufficient. Authority rests with God, not with this document.

METRICS OF FLOURISHING — WHAT WE MEASURE

16.1 Solvens implementing this Agenda should track the following indicators as evidence of progress. These are not prescribed. They are a starting framework to be adapted to the land and the solven.

Indicator	Description
Food Sovereignty	Percentage of food supply grown locally without synthetic inputs. Target: increasing year-on-year.
Water Independence	Percentage of water supply from assembly-controlled sources free of industrial chemical treatment.
Shelter Knowledge	Number of living souls capable of building a habitable structure from local materials without external assistance.
Tally Volume	Total value of exchange conducted in living tally versus debt tally. Target: increasing proportion.
Soil Vitality	Annual measurement of topsoil depth, biological activity and organic matter. Target: improvement.
Sky Quality	Days per year on which the sky meets the blue-sky standard over the settlement. Target: increasing.
Well-being of the Solven	Rates of chronic disease, pharmaceutical dependency and acute illness. Target: decreasing.
Knowledge Transmission	Number of young souls in intergenerational, practice-based learning. Number of elder souls whose living knowledge is being passed on.

16.2 No indicator is a target in itself. The purpose of measurement is to make visible what is improving and what is not, so living souls can act on accurate information rather than aspiration.

16.3 Solvens should report their indicators honestly to the network. A solven that struggles provides more useful knowledge than one that reports only successes. The network learns from difficulty.

CLOSING DECLARATION

There is no one between a living soul and God.

This Agenda does not end here. It begins here.

The living way is not a future state to be administered into existence by institutions and programmes. It is the ordinary life of living men and women who have decided to know where their food comes from, who raised their house, whose water they are drinking and what they are teaching their young.

The chapters above are not a plan to be implemented by a governing body. They are a description of what free souls, acting in common knowledge and common consent, are already doing — and an opening to others who are ready to join them.

Every solven that plants a food forest, mints a living tally, raises a house from earth, revitalises a spring, teaches the young to read the soil and gathers in assembly to decide its own affairs — each such solven is a chapter of this Agenda made living.

The agenda of control requires our dependency. The Agenda for a Living Way requires only our action — and the grace of God, from whom nothing on this earth is hidden and between whom and a living soul no institution was ever truly placed.

— Free Assembly of Living Souls, Draft I